

4.3 Simulation

Let's take a look at some games that can keep those of us with reality fetishes entertained.

SimCity / The Sims

There's something appealing about being able to build and manage an entire city. Games in this genre are generally referred to as God games, and with good reason. After all, you do play a higher power in the functioning of your city.

The first *SimCity* was released in 1989, at a time when most of us still hadn't even discovered computers, let alone computer games. It was immensely popular in the US back then amongst the small group of people who owned PCs (in 1989? Was that like 14 copies sold?). Jokes apart, this is the game that started it all, and although you'd laugh if you saw the look of the game, let's not forget when it was made.

There were several successors to it: *SimCity 2000*, *SimCity 3000*, *SimCity 4* and *SimCity 4 Rush hour*. All these games had you build and maintain a city and keep your populace happy.

The *SimCity* revolution gave way to a new type of game, *The Sims*—that let you control people instead. When you could control intricate lives of people, say, decide whether they should work or not, who wanted to control a city? True, some still did, which is why *SimCity* releases kept coming till 2003, but a lot of gamers switched over to *The Sims* instead.



Games like *The Sims* let you play God